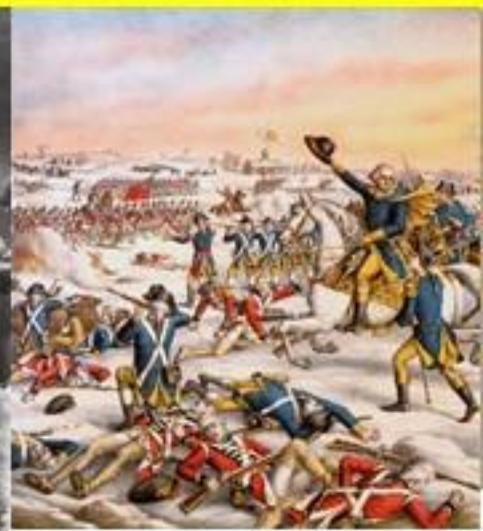


WORLD HISTORY



MODULE – 36

GROWTH OF ASIAN NATIONS - 1

1 Asia is generally divided into South Asia, South East Asia, East Asia and West Asia.

2 Japan and China are part of East Asia.

POWERFUL COUNTRY IN ASIA

- Japan was the only country which was not colonized by the European countries in Asia.
- Though it was geographically a small country, it became a powerful country.
- Japan like the western countries followed a policy of imperialism in Asia.
- It possessed great military strength.
- Today Japan is an economic giant.



- 1 Japan followed a policy of isolation for more than 200 years.
- 2 It was broken by Commodore Perry of the U.S.A. on 8th July 1853.
- 3 His mission paved the way for Japan's trade with the West.
- 4 During this period the Tokugawa Shoguns controlled Japan.
- 5 Perry's mission led to the restoration of the Japanese Emperor to full authority.
- 6 This is known as the Meiji Restoration.

- 7 The Meiji Restoration had initiated many reforms in Japan.



TRANSFORMATION OF JAPAN AFTER MEIJI RESTORATION

- 1** The Meiji restoration was a crucial period of transition of Japan from a pre modern to modern society.
- 2** The Meiji restoration affected all the social, political and economic aspects of Japan as well as its military.
- 3** Meiji restoration able to create a centralized and bureaucratic government.
- 4** The feudal system was abolished. Western legal system was adopted.
- 5** Universal education was introduced to Japan. Schooling combined Western ideas with Japanese culture. So all of a sudden, Japan had a highly educated population with more social mobility.



TRANSFORMATION OF JAPAN AFTER MEIJI RESTORATION

- 6** The traditional samurai system was abolished, and a conscript military, on lines of the west, was created. Modernization of the military was started, which helped it to victory in the Sino- Japanese and the Russo-Japanese wars.
- 7** Adopted the slogan **Wealthy Country and Strong Arms** which proved to be a cardinal doctrine of Japan's imperialist expansion.
- 8** Contacts with the Europeans was encouraged. Even the government was organized on Western lines.



TRANSFORMATION OF JAPAN AFTER MEIJI RESTORATION

- 9** Constitutional Monarchy, as in Britain, was introduced according to the Meiji Constitution.
- 10** A Japanese Parliament called the Diet was setup on lines of the Dutch parliament.
- 11** Trade also increased which leads to development of Banking and financial system.
- 12** In the end, the Meiji restoration was extremely successful. Some of the changes brought are still followed in Japan. It made Japan the developed country it is today.



1 Soon Japan followed a policy of militarism and imperialism. Japan defeated China in 1894-95.

2 Subsequently, it defeated the biggest European country Russia in 1904-05.

3 During the First World War Japan captured the Chinese territory of Shantung which was leased to Germany.

4 It also imposed the 21 Demands on China. Thus, at the end of the First World War, Japan emerged as a superior military power.

5 Hence, in order to control Japan's Navy, the Washington Naval Conference was held in 1921-22. But this was only a temporary measure.



- 1** In 1931 Japan invaded Manchuria and established a puppet regime.
- 2** In 1937 once again Japan invaded China. Finally, it joined with Germany and Italy and formed the axis.
- 3** In 1941, Japan attacked the Pearl Harbour and the U.S.A. entered the Second World War in support of Britain and France and Russia.
- 4** On August 6th and 9th two atom bombs were dropped by the U.S.A. on the Japanese cities of Hiroshima and Nagasaki respectively.

Japan surrendered to the U.S.A.



GENERAL MACARTHUR AND EMPEROR HIROHITO

- 1** After the war, Japan was placed under control of the Supreme Commander, Gen. Douglas MacArthur.
- 2** The new constitution took effect on 3rd May 1947.
- 3** The United States and 45 other Allied nations signed the San Francisco Peace Treaty in September 1951.
- 4** Following the treaty, Japan was made an independent nation once again.



- 1 From the 1950s to the 1980s, Japan's history consists mainly of its rapid development into a major economic power.
- 2 The U.S.A. provided the latest technology to Japan.
- 3 Thus, Japan rapidly rebuilt its heavy industrial sector.
- 4 Japan soon emerged as a significant power in many economic spheres, including steel making, car manufacture and the manufacture of electronic goods.

- 5 Distinguishing characteristics of the Japanese economy include the cooperation of manufacturers, suppliers, distributors, and banks in closely-knit groups called keiretsu emerged.
- 6 For examples Mitsubishi, Sumitomo, Fuyo, Mitsui, Dai-Ichi Kangyo and Sanwa are some of the powerful companies.



ONE PARTY RULE

- Politically, the post-war Japan has been dominated by one party - the Liberal Democratic Party.
- The party remained practically invincible for almost half a century.
- Emperor Hirohito died in 1989 and his son Akihito succeeded.



DEVELOPED COUNTRY

- In the 21st century Japan emerged as a strong economic power.
- Japan is the only Asian country to be included in the group of developed countries.
- Japan is a member of the G7 (Group of developed countries).



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